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r/UCI • 1mo ago

Frequent_Rub2606

Dorm recommendations and application tips for starting in UCI as a freshman

I am an admitted international student majoring in Pharmaceutical Sciences and am thinking of living on-campus during the Fall 2026 school year. I can't decide between Mesa Court and Middle Earth. Which one is better for STEM students who want to study somewhere quiet, while also being able to live closest to where they are studying (like The School of Pharmacy)? Which one is more conveniently located to everything? My options are the classic double rooms and the towers. I heard that the classics are more spacious but have older furniture and experience more maintenance delays compared to the towers, which are more new and provide more modern furniture and better facilities. I also read some reviews on the Middle Earth classics and how they are the worst dorms to live in UCI due to being the oldest and least maintained. Is any of this true or just a myth? Also, for anyone living in quad towers, how is the spacing like and does the room really get that crowded with four people? Are you able to leave your stuff overnight in the shared bathrooms? How many rooms share a bathroom in the classics and can you leave your stuff there? I have never been to Irvine before, and am honestly curious about how things work. It would be very nice if you could provide me some insight on choosing UCI dorms : D



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Unlucky_State_6788 • 1mo ago

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Joined

UC Irvine

A place for UCI Anteaters, and anything UCI related. Discord: <https://discord.gg/uci>

Created Sep 24, 2009

Public

45K
Anteaters1.1K
Hunting for ants

USER FLAIR



Alternative-Shake-41

HELPFUL UCI LINKS

2022-23 Housing Megathread:

https://www.reddit.com/r/UCI/comments/vfp0la/uci_housing_megathread_20222023/

UCI Basic Needs:

<https://basicneeds.uci.edu/>

UCI Disability Services: <https://dsc.uci.edu/>

Borrow a Laptop:

<https://www.lib.uci.edu/mrc/mrc-laptops-and-mobile-devices>

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brandywine dining hall. Personally, I stayed in middle earth towers, and the bathroom sharing with 8 people is more than enough space. If you want a hotel like space, towers, if you want a motel like space, classics. If I could do it again, Mesa Court Towers all the way.

-Also classics are not as spacious as you think, towers are way nicer.



Frequent_Rub2606 OP • 1mo ago

Thanks!



Brilliant-Durian-733 • 1mo ago

Are there any two person per room rooms in Mesa Court, Towers or is it all 4 people to a room?



Unlucky_State_6788 • 1mo ago

Its 4 people to a room but way worth it and cheaper



LeadingOccasion7387 • 28d ago

middle earth towers are closer to most STEM classes, quieter, and overall have better study rooms and facilities than the mesa court towers IMO. i would say that the mesa classics are nicer than middle earth classics, however the towers r much better for me. i wouldn't change my decision any day !! #ilovemiddleearth

[More](#)

Schedule of classes:

<https://www.reg.uci.edu/perl/WebSoc>

Register for classes:

<https://www.reg.uci.edu/registrar/soc/webreg.html> (Academic year)<https://summer.uci.edu/> (Summer)

View fees and balances:

<https://zotaccount.uci.edu/>

Financial aid:

<https://www.ofas.uci.edu/content/> (Log in on the left)

Housing information:

<https://housing.uci.edu/>

Academic calendar:

<https://www.reg.uci.edu/calendars/quarterly/2022-2023/quarterly22-23.html>UCI PD: <https://www.police.uci.edu/>

R/UCI RULES

1 No Inflammatory Language or Harassment

Treat people with respect and argue in good faith.

2 No bigotry

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3 No witch hunts

No posting information about a person or group in a way that encourages a witch hunt, doxxing, or harassment of anyone.

4 No naming TAs, students, and staff

Naming others without the explicit consent of the individual in your post will result in a ban. Staff and faculty are a gray area and will be subject to moderator judgment. Photos of lost items such as IDs should be censored.

5 No illegal activities/academic violations

This includes requests for pirated versions of textbooks and homework services.

6 Please read the FAQ before posting about lost items

Hide sensitive information on lost items <https://tinyurl.com/y3dqwc5q>

7 No non-UCI affiliated promotions

Posts seeking to use UCI students and faculty as a resource will be

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, please refrain from posting requests for commissions, etc. UCI affiliated activities such as clubs and events, as well as survey requests from UCI members are allowed.

8 Do not use this subreddit as a platform for venting about interpersonal or political conflict

9 Users creating conflict that have not participated in the subreddit may be removed

SELF CARE LINKS

Reddit post of student emergency tools:
https://www.reddit.com/r/UCI/comments/w1ooph/how_to_request_assistance_in_a_time_of_crisis/

FREE COUNSELING SESSIONS:

<https://counseling.uci.edu/> A crisis care therapist is available to 24 hours a day 7 days a week.

24-hour national hotline: 1-800-273-8255

Not comfortable with speaking? Text to 741741 and someone will speak with you on the other end. Most major providers will waive texts sent to crisis text line and it will not appear on bills.

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[x.php/pid803578](#)

or send an email to conduct@uci.edu

Medical Services, UCI SHIP alternative:

<https://www.shareourselves.org/>

and dental: <https://www.omidinstitute.org/>

<https://www.lestonnacfreeclinic.org/>

<https://familiestogetheroc.org/>

Communication services for low-income individuals:

<https://www.assurancewireless.com/>

MODERATORS

Message Mods



[u/lingrush](#) Graduate [2019]



[u/Qzhuo](#)
High Winds Beware of Falling Branc...
[Q](#)



[u/Aveldaheilt](#) Consumer of Ants



[u/bofstein](#) Grad [2013]
[Bofstein](#)



[u/Jacxk101](#) Alum - Anthro [2018]
[Jacxkery](#)

[u/SnooRawrBot](#)



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